

# amutheezean.github.io

Personal Academic Portfolio Website

Amutheezean Sivagnanam • Postdoctoral Fellow, University of Houston

<https://amutheezean.com>

## Overview

This repository contains the source code for [amutheezean.com](https://amutheezean.com), the personal academic portfolio of Amutheezean Sivagnanam — Postdoctoral Fellow at the University of Houston with research focus on AI for Transportation Optimization and Reinforcement Learning.

The site is a static website generated by **Jekyll** and hosted on **GitHub Pages** with a custom domain.

## Technology Stack

- **Static site generator:** Jekyll (via the `github-pages` gem)
- **Theme:** Minimal Mistakes v3.4.2, vendored in-repo
- **Templating:** Liquid
- **Stylesheets:** SCSS (compiled by Jekyll)
- **JavaScript:** jQuery + plugins, minified via `uglify-js`
- **Hosting:** GitHub Pages with custom domain ([amutheezean.com](https://amutheezean.com))
- **Comments:** Staticman (configured but inactive)

## Directory Structure

```
.
+-- _config.yml           # Main Jekyll configuration
+-- _config.dev.yml       # Development overrides
+-- Gemfile               # Ruby gem dependencies
+-- package.json          # Node.js build scripts (JS minification)
+-- CNAME                 # Custom domain: amutheezean.com
+-- _data/
|   +-- navigation.yml    # Top-nav menu items
|   +-- authors.yml       # Author metadata (bio, links, avatar)
|   +-- ui-text.yml       # Localized UI strings for the theme
+-- _layouts/             # Liquid HTML layout templates
+-- _includes/            # Reusable Liquid partials (~36 files)
+-- _sass/                # SCSS source modules
+-- assets/               # CSS, JS, and other static assets
+-- _pages/               # Static site pages (about, cv, publications
... )
+-- _publications/        # Research publication entries (6 items)
+-- _talks/               # Conference talk entries (3 items)
+-- _workshops/           # Workshop entries (1 item)
+-- _projects/            # Portfolio project entries (6 items)
+-- _posts/               # Blog posts (~40 entries, 2012–2016)
+-- files/                # Downloadable assets (CV PDF, resumes,
    slides)
+-- images/               # Image assets (50+ files)
```

## Local Development

---

### Prerequisites

- Ruby + Bundler
- Node.js + npm

### Setup

```
bundle install      # Install Jekyll and Ruby gems
npm install         # Install JS build tools (uglify-js, onchange)
```

### Running the Dev Server

```
# Standard (uses production config)
bundle exec jekyll serve

# With development overrides (local URL, no analytics, expanded SASS)
bundle exec jekyll serve --config _config.yml,_config.dev.yml

# With live reload (hawkins gem)
bundle exec hawkins --config _config.yml,_config.dev.yml
```

Site is available at <http://localhost:4000>.

### JavaScript Build

Only needed when editing JS source files in `assets/js/plugins/` or `assets/js/_main.js`:

```
npm run build:js    # Minify all JS into assets/js/main.min.js
npm run watch:js    # Auto-rebuild on changes
```

**Important:** Never edit `assets/js/main.min.js` directly — it is auto-generated by the build script.

## Content Collections

---

### Publications (`_publications/`)

File naming: YYYY-MM-DD-short-slug.md

Required frontmatter fields: `title`, `collection: publications`, `permalink`, `date`, `venue`, `citation`.

### Talks (`_talks/`)

File naming: YYYY-MM-DD-short-slug.md

Required frontmatter fields: `title`, `collection: talks`, `type`, `permalink`, `date`, `venue`, `location`.

### Projects (`_projects/`)

File naming: YYYY-MM-DD-short-slug.md

Frontmatter fields: `title`, `collection: projects`, `permalink`, `date`.

## Common Tasks

---

**Add a publication** Create `_publications/YYYY-MM-DD-slug.md`, optionally add PDFs to `files/`, and update `_pages/cv.md`.

**Add a talk** Create `_talks/YYYY-MM-DD-slug.md` and add slides/posters to `files/Presentations/` and `files/Posters/`.

**Update the CV** Edit `_pages/cv.md` directly (plain Markdown, no special data source).

**Update author bio / social links** Edit `_data/authors.yml`. Fields include `name`, `bio`, `location`, `email`, and social handles.

**Update navigation** Edit `_data/navigation.yml` (the main key controls the top navigation bar).

**Update downloadable files** Replace files directly in the `files/` directory.

## Deployment

---

- **Automatic:** Push to `master` → GitHub Pages rebuilds and publishes.
- **Custom domain:** Controlled by the `CNAME` file (`amutheezan.com`). Do not delete or modify this file.
- **No CI pipeline** — GitHub Pages handles the build.

## What NOT To Do

---

- Do **not** edit `assets/js/main.min.js` directly.
- Do **not** delete `CNAME`.
- Do **not** modify files in `_sass/vendor/`.
- Do **not** add YAML frontmatter (`---`) to files in `assets/`.
- Avoid inline JS `//` comments inside `<script>` tags in layouts (HTML compression removes newlines and breaks them).